

Syntax errors

When you get a syntax error message, it's a hint that you've typed something incorrectly. Perhaps your fingers slipped and hit a wrong letter? Don't worry – these are the easiest errors to fix. Check through your code carefully and try to spot what went wrong.

▷ Things to look out for

Are you missing a bracket or quotation mark? Do your pairs of brackets and quotation marks match? Have you made a spelling mistake? All these things can cause syntax errors.

The closing bracket is missing – it needs another curved bracket here.

```
input('What is your name?'
```

The first quotation mark is missing. It needs to be a single quote to match.

```
print(It is your turn')
```

This is a spelling mistake – it should be `short_shots`.

```
total_score = (long_shots * 3) + (shoort_shots * 2)
```

Indentation errors

Python uses indentation to understand where blocks of code start and stop. An indentation error means something is wrong with the way you've structured the code. Remember: if a line of code ends with a colon (:), the next line must be indented. Press the space bar four times to manually indent a line.

```
if weekday is True:  
print('Go to school')
```

This line of code would trigger an indentation error message.

```
if weekday is True:  
    print('Go to school')
```

Four spaces

You need to indent the code on the second line like this to fix the error.

▽ Indent each new block

In your Python programs, you'll often have one block of code within another block, such as a loop that sits inside a function. Every line in a particular block must be indented by the same amount. Although Python helps by automatically indenting after colons, you still need to check that each block is indented correctly.

Block 1

Block 2

Block 3

Block 2, continuation

Block 1, continuation

The indents tell Python which lines of code belong to which block.

